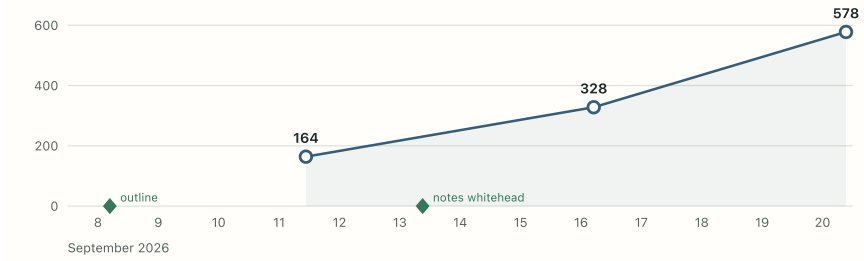
The Map Was the Start of the Argument

PREPARED FOR	RECORDED PERIOD	EVIDENCE PRESERVED
Maya Okafor	Sep 8 – Sep 20, 2026	Sep 27, 2026

> **THE WRITER'S ACCOUNT**
>
> I wrote this essay myself over about two weeks in September. It started as an outline on September 8, and the Whitehead section began as reading notes I typed up on September 13.
>
> The last part, on why the Board of Health rejected Snow, came after the Writing Center asked me about it on September 16. I wrote it in my last few sessions before submitting. I'm happy to walk through any of the drafts with you.

13	6	3	578
days in the recorded timeline	dates with recorded activity	saved drafts	words in the final draft

01 The writing timeline



September 2026

M	T	W	T	F	S	S
	8	9	10	11	12	13
14	15	16	17	18	19	20

6 dates with recorded activity. Highlighted dates come from document records and file timestamps.

Editor metadata 10h 11m editing time recorded by the editor · 14 recorded editing-session markers. These fields support the account; they do not verify time spent writing.

02 How the drafts developed

Carried forward · Wording also in notes · Other new text

01 essay_draft1.docx

Fri Sep 11, 22:40



164 words · 186 min editing

02 essay_draft2.docx

Wed Sep 16, 17:02



328 words · +173 / −9 · 95% of previous kept · 402 min editing

121 new words overlap with notes_whitehead.txt · 49% shared wording

“The person who did the most to confirm Snow's theory started out trying to disprove it. Henry Whitehead was the curate of St Luke's, and he …”

03 essay_final.docx

Sun Sep 20, 21:18



578 words · +272 / −22 · 93% of previous kept · 611 min editing

174 new words new since the previous draft

“Reading the report now, what stands out is not that they ignored the evidence but that they fitted it into the theory they already had. That …”

50 new words

“It is a satisfying story and it is mostly true, but I think it puts the weight in the wrong place. The map did not persuade …”

Green counts wording in the highlighted passages that matches five-word phrases in the notes, ignoring case and punctuation. A match suggests a connection, not proof of origin. Additions appeared between saved drafts; they do not establish a single paste or writing event.

03 The evidence file

5 preserved files · Full SHA-256 fingerprints for verification

NO.	FILE	LAST MODIFIED	SIZE	SHA-256
01	**essay_draft1.docx**	Sep 11, 2026 22:40	3,718 B	`0a6efe21819dc42d628c183ba8ccb3d8332e3e36c949c4e4a3a8a07228c0c20e`
02	**essay_draft2.docx**	Sep 16, 2026 17:02	4,568 B	`e4b77863e88608235752759838c0601ab147b0347ce9f9ad877b2da923ee4878`
03	**essay_final.docx**	Sep 20, 2026 21:18	4,939 B	`b5af296e7d05a471b194dbeb43a0e47f6e8137156c08dc7c03470cfe296070d4`
04	**notes_whitehead.txt**	Sep 13, 2026 21:03	682 B	`dd97f73f1e703fdd608cfacb276b28c215489cbb5f8792945d59b6e01aac59ac`
05	**outline.txt**	Sep 8, 2026 16:45	611 B	`b1a17f554c577dedd7df7a8381e9d8951d12c41ab46204aeb9cff89979d743cc`

Reading this evidence. Dates and editing statistics are recorded by software and can change when files are copied, synced or converted. They support the writer’s account; drafts, notes and live version history remain the primary evidence. File fingerprints confirm file identity, not authorship.